Policy & Strategy Lab

Workbook 7: Options and Choice

Participant	
Name	
Case (problem statement)	
Decision-making role and decision	
Pod	

How to use this workbook

Each worksheet applies one day's anchor tool to your own case. Complete it during the session and finish it in your independent time. Keep earlier versions: revision is credited, so record what changed and why in the feedback box at the end of each worksheet. Tag every substantive claim in your Analyst's Ledger as fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

Competencies practised in this workbook: C4, G1, G2, G3, G4, G5, J2.

Using AI tools. You may use AI tools to suggest structures, rival explanations or improvements to your writing. You may not use AI output as evidence. Every fact, figure, citation and description of an institution must come from a source you have checked.

Worksheet 7.1: Options canvas

Day 16: Generating options. Anchor tool: How Might We questions with a journey map.

Purpose. Generate genuinely different options from the breaks in the affected group's experience.

In brief.

- Generate before you judge; choose tomorrow.
- Build options from the breaks in the affected group's journey.
- Three options must differ in mechanism, not just in scale.
- Include a do-minimum baseline: every option is compared against it.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur: baseline (current contract and campaigns); A, pay for separated collection; B, partner with a waste pickers' cooperative for dry waste; C, a ward enforcement drive. A and B change instruments; C adjusts settings.

Instructions.

1. Map your affected group's journey from published evidence and mark where it breaks.
2. Write a How Might We question for each break.
3. Generate at least eight ideas, then group them into three options that differ in mechanism.
4. Add a do-minimum baseline.
5. Label each option's order of change and run a quick impact and effort screen.

Journey map

Stage	What happens (source)	Break? Why

How Might We questions

Break	How might we...

Options

Option	Mechanism	Order of change	Impact (rough)	Effort (rough)
Baseline: do minimum				

Option	Mechanism	Order of change	Impact (rough)	Effort (rough)
A				
B				
C				

A thinker for your case: Peter Hall. Are you adjusting settings, changing instruments or changing goals?

My answer, in one sentence

Reflection.

1. Hall: does any of your options change an instrument or a goal, or are they all adjustments?
2. Which option follows most directly from your diagnosis?
3. What unintended effect might your favourite option have?

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ The journey is built from published evidence.
- ☐ At least three options that differ in mechanism.
- ☐ A baseline is included.
- ☐ Each option links to a break and to the diagnosis.

Hand in. Worksheet 7.1 by the start of Day 17.

Before the next session. For each option, find one published example of something similar being tried, in India or elsewhere, and note what happened. About 50 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why

Worksheet 7.2: Options appraisal

Day 17: Choosing between options. Anchor tool: Options appraisal matrix with a distributional row.

Purpose. Choose between your options against explicit, weighted criteria, and show what the choice depends on.

In brief.

- State criteria and weights openly: weights are value judgements.
- Every score needs a reason, and the baseline must be scored too.
- Estimate cost per outcome roughly, and say what drives it.
- Test the choice: sensitivity, and value, support and capacity.

Worked example: Madhyapur (a stylised city; figures are illustrative). Madhyapur (illustrative): B scores 3.35, the baseline 3.15, A 3.00 and C 2.30. B is robust to the weights but sensitive to the cooperative's reach. Recommendation: B in ten pilot wards now, moving to A at contract renewal. Weakest leg: operational capacity.

Instructions.

1. Choose your criteria and weights, and write why each weight is what it is.
2. Score each option and the baseline, with a reason for every score.
3. Estimate rough cost per unit of outcome, stating the assumptions.
4. Change one weight or assumption and see whether the ranking holds.
5. Test your preferred option on the public value triangle and name the weakest leg.

Criteria and weights

Criterion	Weight	Why this weight

Appraisal matrix (score 1 to 5, reason in the notes)

Criterion	Baseline	Option A	Option B	Option C
Effectiveness				
Cost				
Administrative feasibility				
Political feasibility				

Criterion	Baseline	Option A	Option B	Option C
Distribution: who gains, who pays, who is left out				
Risk and reversibility				
Weighted score				

Cost per outcome

Option	Cost (source or assumption)	Outcome (estimate and assumption)	Cost per unit

Sensitivity

What I changed	Does the ranking change?	What the recommendation depends on

Public value test

Leg	How the preferred option scores	How the plan strengthens it
Public value		
Legitimacy and support		
Operational capacity		

A thinker for your case: Mark Moore, with Charles Lindblom. Does the option create public value, can it win legitimacy and support, and is there the capacity to deliver it?

My answer, in one sentence

Reflection.

1. Which weight is the biggest value judgement in your appraisal? Would your decision-maker share it?
2. What does your recommendation give up, and for whom?
3. Lindblom: would a sequence of smaller steps be wiser than a single choice?

My reflections

My reflections

Quality checklist.

- ☐ Weights stated and argued.
- ☐ Every score has a reason.
- ☐ The baseline is scored.
- ☐ Cost per outcome with assumptions.
- ☐ Sensitivity tested.
- ☐ The weakest leg of the triangle is named.

Hand in. Worksheet 7.2 by the start of Day 18. Pods check each other's appraisals in the last ten minutes of today's session; the instructor comments in writing before Day 18.

Before the next session. Write your recommendation in one paragraph: what, by whom, by when, at what cost, and what it depends on. About 45 minutes.

Feedback and revision

Feedback received (peer or instructor)	What I changed, and why